RIYADVI / FIELD GUIDE

Software Project Planning Guide

Define the problem. Align the team. Build with intent.

01 CLARITY	02 SCOPE	03 DELIVERY
Goals & outcomes	Priorities & trade-offs	Risks & launch readiness

A practical guide for better project conversations

A useful software project begins before the first line of code. Use this guide to align stakeholders, reduce uncertainty and make the important decisions visible.

1. Define the outcome

- What business problem are we solving?
- Who experiences the problem, and in what context?
- What measurable change would make the project successful?
- What is explicitly out of scope?

2. Understand the users

- List primary user groups and their most important tasks.
- Map the current journey and identify friction points.
- Check accessibility, language, device and connectivity needs.
- Validate assumptions with real users when possible.

3. Set scope and priorities

- Separate must-have, should-have and later features.
- Describe the smallest useful release.
- Document dependencies, integrations and data requirements.
- Agree who can approve scope changes.

4. Plan delivery

- Name a decision owner and day-to-day project contact.
- Break work into reviewable milestones.
- Agree on feedback turnaround times and demo cadence.
- Define acceptance criteria before implementation begins.

5. Plan for security and quality

- Identify personal or sensitive data that will be handled.
- Choose authentication, authorization and retention requirements.
- Include responsive, accessibility and performance checks.
- Plan backups, monitoring, error reporting and recovery.

6. Prepare for launch

- Confirm domain, hosting, database and environment ownership.
- Prepare production secrets outside source control.
- Test critical journeys with realistic data.
- Document rollback, support ownership and post-launch priorities.

7. Questions to answer before kickoff

- What is the most important outcome?
- Who signs off on scope and design?
- What systems must the product connect to?
- What constraints exist around budget, timing or compliance?
- How will we know whether the launch worked?

Planning worksheet

Business goal: _____

Primary users: _____

Success measures:

_____

Must-have scope:

_____

Known risks: _____

Decision owner: _____

Target milestone:

_____

Open questions:

_____

This guide is a general planning aid, not legal, security or delivery advice for a specific project. Adapt it to your organization and verify requirements with the relevant stakeholders.